

Daan Rijpkema

Senior Software Engineer
Backend | Cloud | Product Engineering | Architecture
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Summary

Senior Software Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing and building backend, full-stack, and cloud-native systems across large-scale e-commerce, SaaS, and product-facing environments. Strong background in PHP, TypeScript, Java, AWS, GraphQL, REST APIs, event-driven architecture, testing, observability, and scalable software architecture. Combines hands-on engineering with product ownership, mentoring, and a founder's mindset from building and operating a SaaS platform used by 60+ organizations and businesses.

Selected Highlights

- 10+ years of professional software development experience across backend, full-stack, SaaS, and cloud-native systems.
- Senior Backend Developer at Coolblue, working on product management, catalog, navigation, search/filter, advisory, and product-page systems.
- Founder of Codex, a SaaS platform used by 60+ organizations and businesses across four Dutch cities.
- Hands-on experience with PHP, TypeScript, Java, AWS CDK, Lambda, API Gateway, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, RDS/Aurora MySQL, GraphQL, REST, TDD, CI/CD, and software architecture.
- Former Google Business Associate Intern focused on fraud detection, anti-abuse strategies, data analysis, and product policy.
- Experienced mentor, coach, and technical contributor in product-oriented engineering environments.

Professional Experience

Senior Backend Developer - Coolblue

Senior | February 2022 - Present | Netherlands | coolblue.nl

- Build and scale backend services for product management, product catalog, navigation, search/filtering, advisory customer journeys, and product-page domains in a large Dutch e-commerce environment.
- Develop cloud-native systems using AWS CDK, Lambda, API Gateway, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, RDS/Aurora MySQL, RDS Proxy, Redis/ElastiCache, OpenSearch, and related infrastructure.
- Design and maintain API and distributed-system boundaries across GraphQL, Apollo Federation/Supergraph patterns, REST APIs, event-driven architecture, and queue-based processing.
- Work with data-intensive systems involving MySQL/Aurora, DynamoDB, Redis, OpenSearch, AWS DMS, read models/projections, and migration reliability.
- Work across PHP, TypeScript, and Java codebases, with a strong focus on maintainability, testing, and operational reliability.
- Apply TDD, integration & acceptance testing, load testing with k6, Datadog / OTEL observability, production diagnostics, CI/CD, and Docker-based local development workflows.
- Contribute to architecture, design discussions, engineering standards, and pragmatic process improvements from the senior engineering competency.
- Mentor colleagues through code review, technical coaching, knowledge sharing, and pragmatic engineering practices.
- [TODO: add 1-3 concrete achievements, such as a migration, performance improvement, reliability improvement, cost reduction, team/process improvement, product impact, or scale metric.]

Founder - Codex by Styx Software

Founder, sole proprietorship | December 2013 - February 2025

- Founded and built Codex, a web-based administration and analytics SaaS platform for student organizations, associations, and small-to-medium businesses.
- Designed and developed integrated CMS, ERP, HR, CRM, and analytics functionality with third-party service integrations.

- Scaled the platform to 60+ businesses and associations across four Dutch cities, supporting administrative workflows for thousands of students.
- Owned the full product lifecycle: discovery, development, infrastructure, support, customer onboarding, and long-term maintenance.
- Automated repetitive administrative processes and improved reporting, membership, finance, and operational workflows.
- [TODO: add core technology stack if accurate, e.g. PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, Linux, hosting/infrastructure, or payment/email integrations.]

Freelance Software Developer / Product Engineer

September 2008 - Present

- Built websites, web applications, automation tools, and digital products for independent clients.
- Combined software engineering, UX/design, client communication, and delivery ownership from concept through maintenance.
- [TODO: add 1-2 representative projects, client types, technologies, or measurable outcomes.]

Business Associate Intern, Product Quality Operations - Google

June 2014 - September 2014

- Developed fraud detection and anti-abuse strategies using data analysis and product-policy evaluation.
- Analyzed datasets to improve fraud prevention, policy decisions, and operational understanding.
- Organized a technical/data-focused meetup and received internal recognition for supporting colleagues with data analysis and programming.

Technical Skills

- Languages: PHP, TypeScript, Java, Python
- Backend & APIs: GraphQL, Apollo Federation/Supergraph patterns, REST APIs, serverless architectures, event-driven systems, queue-based processing, service boundaries, product/catalog systems
- Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, CDK, Lambda, API Gateway, S3, SQS/SNS, DynamoDB, RDS/Aurora MySQL, RDS Proxy, Redis/ElastiCache, OpenSearch, CloudFront, Docker, Linux, CI/CD
- Data & Search: MySQL, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Redis, OpenSearch/Elasticsearch, Cassandra, AWS DMS, read models/projections
- Engineering Practices: TDD, integration testing, load testing, k6, Datadog, observability, production diagnostics, software architecture, code review, mentoring, process improvement
- Additional: functional programming with Haskell and Scala, data analysis with Python and Julia, cybersecurity, automation

Education

BSc Computer Science - Utrecht University

September 2011 - September 2015

- Completed a final-year virtual software company project with an eight-person team, building a modular digital learning and work environment with third-party integrations and blended-learning functionality.
- Worked as coach and analytics developer, leading meetings, supporting team members, and focusing on learning analytics.

MSc Artificial Intelligence - Utrecht University

September 2017 - February 2019 | thesis phase paused

- Completed MSc-level coursework and paused during the thesis phase.

Community & Leadership

- Founding board member and Secretary of Study Association Sticky; led communications, events, alumni initiatives, and internal tooling.
- Designed and developed StickyPay, an RFID/NFC payment system, and StickyAdmin, a PHP-based administration system that digitized internal workflows.

- Founded and organized the Indievelopment conference, growing attendance from 140 to 440 visitors and managing budgets up to EUR20,000.
- Team Captain and Founder of the Enactus Utrecht Think Tank; led a creative team developing social enterprise concepts and advising existing ventures.
- Volunteer bartender at Poppodium EKKO, an alternative music venue in Utrecht.

Interests

Electronic music production and DJing, endurance sports, cycling, yoga, writing, and chess.